

Remembering Barnes

By C.G.S.Narayanan

World Federation for chess composition (WFCC) in its website paid a tribute to British composer Barry Peter Barnes (1937-2025) who was a tireless promoter of the best in chess composition art for 70 years, since his first published problem in 1954. With his contemporaries Michael Lipton and John Rice, in the late 1950s and early 1960s he revolutionised the British two-mover, moving from the single phase content to modern multiphase content. Their joint book *"The Two-Move Chess Problem: Tradition and Development"* (1966) was a glorious monument to their revolution. He earned the FIDE IM title and title of International Judge of Chess Composition. Barry was a good friend and inspiration to many Indian composers. The first problem below is an elegant cross-checker in a Meredith.

B.P.Barnes
2nd prize, Evening news 1959
Brian Harley award winner



Mate in two moves

Key 1.Kb3! (2.Qb4)

1...Bc1+ 2.fNd3; 1...Bd4+ 2.eNd3
Bxf2+ 2.eNf3

and the second one sent to me five years back was fairly recent success of his on which the judge Marjan

Kovacevic wrote " how much I liked the quintet of mates after black queen moves"

B.P.Barnes
1st PreaTomas Salamanca MT 2020



Mate in two moves

Set: 1...Qxf4 2.Qxe4

Key 1.Nxe4! (2.Rf2); 1...Kxf4 2.Rxf5
1...Qxf4+ 2.Nd6; 1...Qe5+ 2.fxe5
1...Qxe4 2.fxg5; 1...Qd5 2.Nxg5
1...Qxh3 2.Nf6

"I think my old mentor, Comins Mansfield, would have approved using WQ as mere bishop wrote Barnes.

The problem for solving was a probably the fore-runner in the theme of cyclic refutation

B.P.Barnes
First prize, Problemnoter 1961



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Turton doubling'

Key 1.Rh4! Kc5. Rgg4 any 3.Rc4
Brunner-Dresden doubling- doubling between line pieces of equal strength

Readers may send in their queries to
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